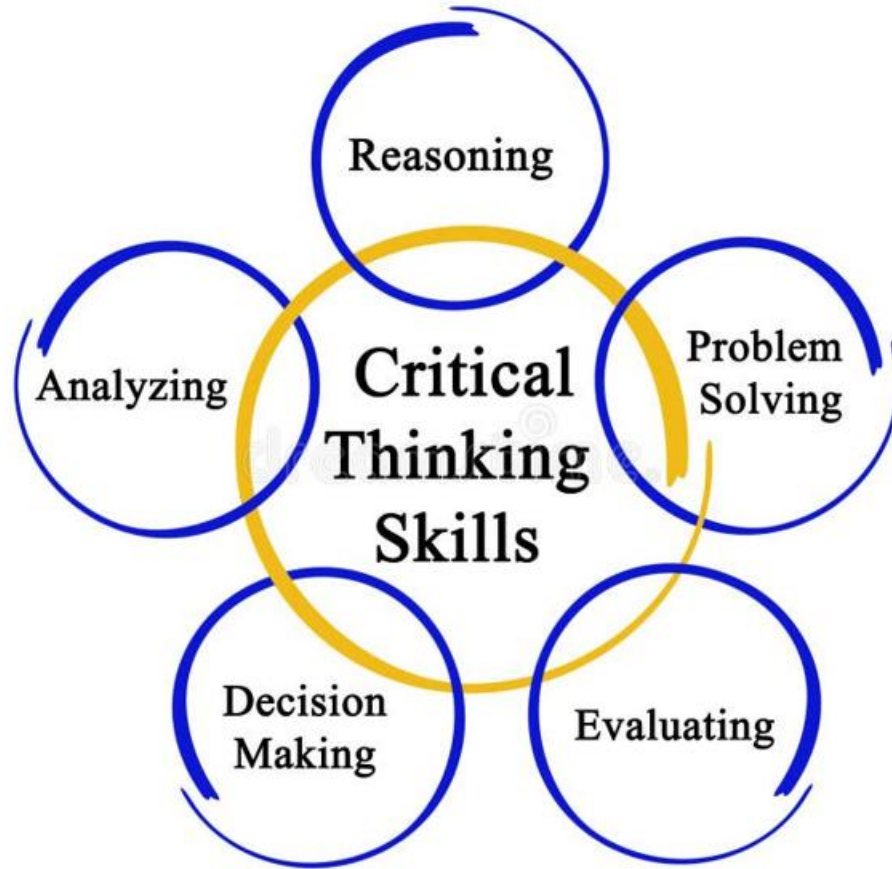




Problem Solving And Decision Making Skills

Dr / Mayada Mahmoud

What is Problem Solving?

- **Problem Solving is :** Identifying solutions to specific issues.
- **Steps:** understand, brainstorm, evaluate, implement.
- **Importance:** from everyday problems to academic challenges.



What is Decision Making?

- **Decision Making:** Choosing between alternatives based on logic and reasoning.
- **Involves:** risk assessment, consequences, and goals.
- **Examples:** time management, career choices, group projects.



Decision Making

Critical Thinking in Problem Solving

- **Steps:**

- 1. Define the problem
- 2. Analyze the situation (Gather information)
- 3. Generate possible solutions (Identify alternatives)
- 4. Evaluate and select the possible solutions
- 5. Choose and implement the solution.
- 6. Review and monitor .



Critical Thinking in Decision Making

- Tools used:
- **SWOT analysis** (**S**trengths, **W**eaknesses, **O**pportunities, **T**hreats).

- Pros and cons list.
- Root cause analysis



- Emphasizes objectivity and rational analysis.

Barriers to Effective Problem Solving





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Mini Case 1: The Internship Dilemma

- Scenario:

- You've been offered a summer internship that overlaps with an important final project.

- Discussion:

- What are the pros and cons?
- What info do you need?
- What factors influence your choice?

Mini Case 2: Team Conflict in Group Assignment

- **Scenario:**

- Your group project is due in 4 days, but two members aren't contributing.

- **Discussion:**

- What is the root cause?
- What are possible solutions?
- How to address the team issue?
- How can critical thinking help?

Mini Case 3: Choosing a Major

- Scenario:

- You're torn between two majors (e.g., psychology and microbiology). Parents and friends have different opinions.

- Discussion:

- How to analyze your options?
- What tools can help?
- How to balance interests vs. expectations?